

Parish News

Kington, Huntington & Titley

August 2026



£1

THE KINGTON PARISHES



**St Mary, Kington; St Thomas a Becket, Huntington
St Stephen, Old Radnor; St Mary, Kinnerton; St Peter, Titley**
www.kingtonparishes.org.uk

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St. Mary's, Kington PCC is a registered charity and its number is 1185453

From our Vicar

Dear Friends

As we head into the (hopefully) sunny days of August, we notice an increase in visitor numbers here in this usually uncrowded part of the UK. We will never be ‘crowded’ but an increase in busyness will remind us that we are not alone in this place, and that we are not immune from the effect of others, however isolated we might think we are. Almost daily we are witnesses to the power of the ‘crowd’ – small businesses are begun through ‘crowd funding’; reputations are created from nothing using the power of TikTok, Instagram and other forms of social media; people’s livelihoods and lives are destroyed by the sudden outpouring of anger or rage that can be whipped up around the world to condemn the words or actions of an individual.

The crowds of people who followed Jesus, praised him, hailed him as a leader, protected

him from those who would do him harm and, ultimately, betrayed him. Jesus loved the people who surrounded him, both as individuals and as a group, but he was remarkably clear-sighted about the nature of that crowd, and always aware of the surprising amount of power it held.

The philosopher Michel Foucault’s wrote that ‘people know what they do; frequently they know why they do what they do; but what they don’t know is what they do, does’ highlighting the often unintended gap between our conscious actions, our motives, and the broader, unintended consequences of our behaviour. We are warned that we should always be on our guard against allowing ourselves to be swayed by the opinion of the crowd without having first established the truth as far as we can; we must not let our voice to be appropriated by others and used for evil. However, nor should we be afraid to let our voice be heard - there rests with us the responsibility for using that voice to bring the attention of our community and our world to acts of injustice, ignorance or hatred. And from our words should grow actions; deeds which rescue, restore and renew our faith in ourselves and in each other.

Sally



***And from our words
should grow actions;
deeds which rescue,
restore and renew our
faith in ourselves and
in each other.***

An Apology

In the July edition of KPN, the article “Farewell to Stephen” in memory of Stephen Gilling, mentioned his wife, Marion Giddings which should of course have been Marion Gilling.

Both the Editor and contributor extend their heartfelt apologies to the family for this error.

From the Archdeacon of Ludlow

Journeys

Iwonder how many journeys you have planned in your lifetime: the daily trips and the longer adventures; the familiar routes we take almost on autopilot, and the journeys we plan carefully because of where we are going, or what we hope to do and see.

There are the journeys we make every day—to work, to school, or to see a neighbour.

There are the journeys we make less often, but still regularly: visiting relatives, going to church, or attending commitments. And then there are the journeys we may make only once in a lifetime. Each journey has a purpose, a beginning and an end: to see a loved one, to celebrate, to earn a living, to shop for food, to visit the doctor, to take a holiday, or to explore somewhere new.

As a family, we recently spent hours planning the route and places to stay for a road trip through Italy—from Lake Como to Naples and back. We wanted to visit the places on our “we would really like to see” list, while also making time to rest, explore and enjoy

being together.

The planning resulted in a wonderful holiday: we saw amazing things, experienced busyness and rest, encountered a different culture, and came home refreshed—physically, emotionally and spiritually.

Throughout the Bible there is a great deal of journeying, and often in those physical journeys we see God at work in the lives of those who travel. We see the Israelites rescued by God and formed as his people; Elijah running away and discovering that God is with him; Paul shipwrecked yet protected so that he can speak to others about Jesus; and Jesus journeying to the cross, revealing God’s ultimate love through his words and actions along the way.

At the beginning of July, I was part of two joyful services as Bishop Richard ordained our new priests and deacons. As I sat through those services, I was reminded again of journeys—not physical journeys this time, but spiritual ones: the journeys we make with God as we respond to his call and leading. As followers of Jesus, we are called by God into his service, a calling that takes many shapes and forms. Like our physical journeys, our spiritual journeys have a purpose. Paul speaks of doing whatever we do to the glory of God, and Jesus teaches that in all we do we reveal God to others—his light, his life and his love. So, as we head into a season of holiday journeys, I wonder whether we might use the opportunity of a physical journey to reflect on our spiritual one, from beginning to end.

The Venerable Sam Hustwayte



**... Jesus journeying
to the cross, revealing
God’s ultimate love
through his words
and actions along
the way...**



St Thomas a Becket, Huntington

Kington Benefice Pilgrim Path Walk 2026

The Huntington guided circular pilgrim trail walk will take place on Sunday 16th August, from St Thomas a Becket (HR5 3RR). Meeting at the church at 1:45pm for a prompt 2:00pm start. The walk will be shorter this year (being approx. 1.5 miles). Refreshments will be provided on return to the church.

The walk is free but booking is essential as places are limited. If you have any queries, please contact Sally – vicar@kingtonparishes.org.uk / Tel.No: 07974 439630. If you would like to book a place, please contact Judith Pollard – wotzpollard@aol.com

Walk & Pizza Event

This ever popular event will take place on Sunday 30th August. Those who wish to walk should meet at Yew Tree Farm, Huntington, HR5 3PG, for a prompt 2:00pm start. If you don't wish to walk but would like to enjoy a pizza, meet at Yew Tree Farm from 5:30pm. See attached poster for full details.

Kington Community Shop

Members of Huntington Church and Village Hall are once again joining forces to run the Kington Community Shop, from Wednesday 29th July for one week. If you have anything you would like to donate, ideally please bring items along to the shop on Tuesday 28th July from 5:00pm onwards. This is when the shop is being set up ready for opening the following day. However, if this is not convenient, then please drop any items into the shop when it is open on either Wednesday or Thursday.

Susan Maiden

Huntington Village Walk, Pizza and Pudding Sunday 30th August

Meet at Yew Tree Farm
HR5 3PG

Walk at 2pm

Pizza from 5:30pm

Non walkers and/or non pizza eaters
welcome, join us for the bit you fancy!

£10 per person

Pre booking essential

Pippa and Mike Lloyd

yewtreepottery@gmail.com or 01544 370692

Please bring your own drinks.

St. Mary's Church, Kington

I see that when I wrote the report for the July edition, I wondered if we would be having a heatwave when I next wrote... We certainly are, it is 33° Celsius in our garden at the moment. I do hope you are all keeping fairly cool.

Ordination

Phillippa was ordained Priest at a splendid service in Hereford Cathedral on 4th July, and on the following day we held a celebratory bring and share lunch in church after her first Communion service. We all wish her well in her ministry over the coming years.

Church Fete

This was very successful, held in beautiful weather in the church and churchyard. The church was full of people having teas, listening to the community choir, and chatting, a lovely community occasion. The outside stalls were much enjoyed, and £1,135 was raised for church funds. We give many thanks to all who helped in any way, and especially to Phillippa who organised much of the event.

Church floor

We have now uncovered the tiles in the vestry and are awaiting professional advice from the tile restorers. The red hearing loop tape that was visible on the floor has been replaced with cable, so the church is looking a lot neater, and the loop is working well. The church is open from 9am until around 5pm daily, with DIY tea and coffee, if you wish to come and view the changes.

Choral Evensong

Evensong will be sung in church on Sunday August 9th at 4pm by the Derby Singers, and will be followed by a short recital, and then tea and cakes. Do come along, it will be a very special occasion.

There will be further concerts later in the year, beginning with an organ recital in September, details to follow...



– Kington Creations –

St Mary's Lego Club

Thousands of bricks, Lots of mini figures,
Loads of fun !

Wednesday 19th August

3:30pm – 5:00pm

St Marys Church Kington

Young children to be accompanied
by an adult please

Refreshments available
legoclub.kington@gmail.com

Having fun creating together

The Dove

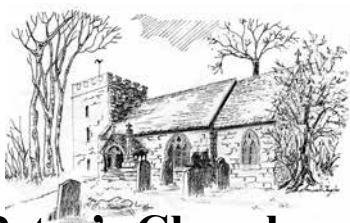
On Sunday August 23rd, as part of the Vintage street market, there will be a variety of stalls in the courtyard of the Dove, (previously the Wine Vaults). There will also be an opportunity to look inside, and see what is planned for the Dove, and to give us your ideas for its future use.

Many of our usual activities continue over the summer, including Beetle drives on the 2nd Tuesday of the month, and Lego Club. There will also be activities for children over the summer holidays, which will be publicised nearer the time.

We wish you an enjoyable, and not too hot, time during the summer, and hope you may be able to join us for some of our events.

With our very best wishes to you all,

*Margaret Cooke and Greg Wright,
churchwardens.*



St. Peter's Church Titley

Readers

Sunday 2nd August 8.30am Dick

Sunday 16th August 10am David.

Thanks

I would like to express my thanks for all the help in getting the church prepared for the service of thanksgiving for Quita. It was standing room only and the service depicted the special person she was. She will be sadly missed.

Village Fete

Last reminder that the Village Fete takes place on Saturday 8th August starting at 2pm on the Stagg Meadow by kind permission of David. Hopefully this fine weather will continue and there will be lots for people to see not forgetting the famous Titley Teas.

Community Shop

Again, another reminder that we are running the shop in September. Any offers of help or anything to help stock the shop would be greatly appreciated. All enquiries to Judith on 01544 230734

Many thanks

Dick

Dates, Diaries and Calendars

We need diaries and calendars to remind us of special events, anniversaries, birthdays and important appointments.

The Church of England has a calendar called a Lectionary providing a set of prayers and bible readings to be used throughout the year. The calendar starts on the four Sundays before Christmas called the Advent Season.

From Christmas through until Easter Day, the focus of the prayers and readings tells of Jesus' earthly life spend teaching people about the love of God and the response to this. When reading the bible, we should try and be part of the story. Using our imagination looking up the geography of Palestine, of Bethlehem and Jerusalem. The places where Jesus and his disciples walked and talked with people. Healing the sick, proclaiming the Good News of the Divine love. Facts sometimes hard to believe in our modern world and yet tr facts and faith hold together in the greatest truth of all time. All of history leads us to cross and then flows to the end of time.

"Now is our time" hold fast to our faith in a troubled world of warfare and suppressions of freedom in many parts.

Faith must lead to a deeper understanding of the divine love and our response to it in disciplined discipleship.

Tony Jardine

For all advertising enquiries please contact:
pn.kingtonparishes@gmail.com

Kington Parishes: August 2026

Sunday, 2nd Trinity 9

Genesis 32:22-31, Psalm 17:1-7, Romans 9:1-5, Matthew 14:13-21

8.30am:	Holy Communion:	Titley
10.00am:	Holy Communion:	Kington *
6.00pm:	Junior Praise:	Old Radnor
6.00pm:	Praise and Prayer Evening:	Kington

Sunday, 9th Trinity 10

Genesis 37:1-4, 12-28, Psalm 105:1-6, 16-22, Romans 10:5-15, Matthew 14:22-33

8.30am:	Holy Communion:	Huntington
10.00am:	Holy Communion with Baptism:	Kington *
11.30am	Holy Communion:	Old Radnor
5.00pm:	Choral Evensong: (sung by the Derby Singers)	Kington+

Sunday, 16th Trinity 11

Genesis 45:1-15, Psalm 133, Romans 11:1-2a, 29-32, Matthew 15(10-20)21-28

10.00am:	Holy Communion:	Titley
10.00am:	Morning Praise:	Kington *
6.00pm:	Evening Prayer:	Old Radnor

Sunday, 23rd Trinity 12

Exodus 1:8-2.10, Psalm 124, Romans 12:1-8, Matthew 16:13-20

10.00am:	Holy Communion:	Kington *
6.00pm:	Sung Evensong:	Huntington

Sunday, 30th Trinity 13

Exodus 3:1-15, Psalm 115, Romans 12:9-end, Matthew 16:21-end

10.00am:	Holy Communion (Group Service) in Kington *
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* These services are live streamed.

WEEKDAY SERVICES

Morning Prayer takes place at 9am in Kington every Monday, Wednesday and Friday, and Evening Prayer at 4pm on Mondays. All are welcome.

If you or a loved one are unable to make the services at St Mary's but would appreciate prayers or Communion by extension at home, please contact Phillippa (the Curate).

Reader Writes

The unaccustomed pleasures and challenges of a heatwave haven't worn off yet; and it must be admitted that living in rural Herefordshire provides numerous opportunities for turning unfamiliar trial to absolute pleasure. Lifting my rather rust speckled garlic at 7 in the morning was certainly a joy, others in urban flats, might die for; and walking round Park Wood in cool shade without another soul was a special treat. Our huge medieval stone church has also been gloriously cool.

In the sermon on the mount Jesus commands: "You are the salt of the earth, but if the earth loses its saltiness, how can it be made salty again?" and he goes on "You are the light of the world. A city on a hill cannot be hidden.

In the same way, let your light shine before men." These heatwaves, it is now agreed, are symptoms of climate breakdown revealing not only physical danger but extreme risk to food production. In the cool of a woodland walk we have time to think about the costs and the risks before plunging back into the reality of wilting plants and uncomfortable children. These radical teachings of Jesus must be grasped with both hands. Where should Christians stand on his very present challenge of climate change.

So no hysterics please; our very large neighbour across the Atlantic commented that Andy Burnham was "extremely liberal" and then speculated that Burnham would be unlikely to open up the North Sea for more oil exploration. The almost unrestrained burning of coal, oil and gas has created the climate wreckage that we face now. And there is almost zero legal and practical

infrastructure for managing and reducing the rise in mean temperatures. At the same time there is irreversible breakdown and depletion in living ecosystems upon which global food production depends. You don't have to be "extremely liberal" to see that and to ask how a Christian should be responding and should be challenging the powerful and the privileged.

The bleak reality is that our global economic system is based on the "invisible doctrine" of Neoliberalism. It's invisible because of the

conspiracy, as many see it, of keeping the system of market privilege going, including through a complex web of think tanks, presenting as academic institutions. That's the capitalist system that allows a small minority to accumulate unprecedented wealth whilst driving the majority into poverty and some 10% into destitution.

There are many academics, Prof Olivier De Schutter for example, arguing hard for changes to our reliance on GDP as the economic driver. Infinite growth is producing extreme poverty.

Andy Burnham has the punishingly hard job of trying to turn his "extreme liberalism" into policies that survive the political systems of government. If he has a vision for change, of disconnecting GDP from growth for example, he will get enthusiastic support from the many who are beginning to see that there is a better and fairer world that the super-rich are trying to hide from view. So, what would Jesus tell us to do? We are not just to manage the fall-out from the human, climate and ecological catastrophes we are manufacturing. We are to be radical; what else can we be when told that we are the salt of the earth and the light of the world?

Robert MacCurrach

"We are to be radical; what else can we be when told that we are the salt of the earth and the light of the world?"

God by Numbers

8 There are 8 essential vitamin Bs our bodies need for good health. In a turbulent world Jesus modelled 8 essential B-attitudes that promote health in society and bring blessing to us. (Matthew 5:3-10)

Blessed are the poor in spirit, for theirs is the kingdom of heaven - Jesus emptied himself into our emptiness so that heaven would overflow into our broken world.

Blessed are they who mourn, for they shall be comforted - Jesus wept with Lazarus' sisters. Suffering our loss as his own, Jesus comforts us that we might share tears with those who mourn.

Blessed are the meek, for they shall inherit the earth - Jesus stripped himself to wash his disciples' feet. Although the earth is his footstool, he washed our feet for service to lift others to his throne.

Blessed are they who hunger and thirst for righteousness, for they shall be satisfied - Jesus revealed the restorative nature of God's justice, like a feast restoring h-angry bodies so we welcome others to the table.

Blessed are the merciful, for they shall be shown mercy - Jesus lavishes us with undeserved forgiveness that, having plenty for ourselves, we also have an abundance to share with those we might consider undeserving of it!

Blessed are the pure in heart, for they shall see God - Jesus lived in the pure joy of his Father's likeness, so that we, made in God's image, would recognize his likeness in those around us.

Blessed are the peacemakers, for they shall be called children of God - Jesus, the Prince of peace, calls us actively to promote peace and reconciliation.

Blessed are they who are persecuted for righteousness' sake, for theirs is the kingdom of heaven - Jesus said you will suffer as he had suffered for walking along the road to heaven. But remember where It leads!

Robert MacCurrach and David Stearns

A Day Out in August!

Visit

Kington Art and Craft Market

Saturday 18th August

9:30am – 3:00pm

Kington Market Hall
and Place de Marines.

Kington Art & Craft Market

offers a wide variety of unique
items from different
local Artists and Crafters.

We have something for everyone.

Our stalls include pottery,
basketry, handmade cards,
sewn, crochet & knitted items,
stone painting engraving,
jewellery, honey products plus
work from local artists.

It is the perfect place to find a
Birthday, Wedding Gift or Card.

So please put the date in your
diary, pop along to see us and
support local artists and crafters
in their work.

***We look forward to seeing
you on 18th August***

Herefordshire Historic Churches Trust

*Recital by Carlo Fierens, Professor of Classical Guitar
at Trapani University, Italy*

St Peter and St Paul Church, Weobley HR4 8SD.

19.00 Saturday, 29th August 2026

Having just finished a series of masterclasses, followed by a concert in Manila, Carlo Fierens returns to Herefordshire by popular demand to play a selection of pieces showing his skill and love of the classical guitar.

£12.50 to include canapés. Wine and soft drinks available. Tickets on the door or via <https://www.tickettailor.com/events/herefordshirehistoricchurchestrust/2181046>

All proceeds in aid of Herefordshire Historic Churches Trust (reg charity no 511181) and Weobley church.

Wordsearch for August 2026

John the Baptist

This month, on the 29th, we remember John the Baptist. By all accounts, he had a rough life. He grew up in obscurity, lived in the desert on a diet of bugs. He wore itchy camel hair. He worked in the heat of the sun, constantly challenging people, and wading in and out of muddy Jordan waters to baptise many. Then he was arrested and kept in a reeking, infested dungeon until one day they cut his head off. Not much comfort in that life. Yet the Bible tells us that of all the people in history, no one has even been born who was as great as him. Why?

Because of the unique calling God gave him, which was to prepare the way for the coming ministry of his Son, Jesus. Jesus did not have an easy life, either.



<i>John</i>	<i>Desert</i>	<i>Sun</i>	<i>Arrested</i>	<i>History</i>
<i>Baptist</i>	<i>Bugs</i>	<i>Challenge</i>	<i>Dungeon</i>	<i>Great</i>
<i>Rough</i>	<i>Camel</i>	<i>Muddy</i>	<i>Head</i>	<i>Unique</i>
<i>Obscurity</i>	<i>Heat</i>	<i>Jordan</i>	<i>Cut</i>	<i>prepare</i>

Please see page 22 for answers

Operation Dove

I am writing this report on 8th July, ready for the August edition of the Parish News, and at last we have some small progress to report on the planning application. It has now been officially “validated” which means that the Herefordshire planning department agree that they have received all the information that they need to consider the application. Yesterday (7th July) we had a useful visit from two representatives of the department – one from the Historic Buildings and one from the Planning – and we are now just waiting for the decision. We also now have a yellow planning notice on the front gate where comments from the public are invited by 29th July.

The Dove has now had all of the old wiring removed and has been cleared of all clutter ready for repairs to be done to the floor which has some quite large holes in the floorboards where pipes associated with the delivery of beer from the cellar have been removed.

We are fairly confident that we will be able to open the Dove to the public on Sunday 23rd August during the Kington Street Market, and that we will have a display of plans and future activities so that you can all see how the building will be used. This will be in addition to fundraising stalls in the courtyard and Yarn Barn where refreshments will be available all day, including the Church Cream Teas which will be redirected from St Mary’s church for that day only. (See separate notices in this edition of Parish News.)

We have continued to welcome people to the Yarn Barn during the five weeks we have been open, and we have met some lovely people who without exception have been enthusiastic about the activities on offer. Why not drop in on any Monday or Wednesday morning between 10am and 12noon for a look around, a coffee and a chat – we’d love to see you.

Freda and Alison
yarnbarn37@gmail.com

In aid of St Mary’s Church, Kington

As part of

Kington Street Fair

Sunday 23rd August

10am - 4pm

Fundraising Open Day

at

The Dove, Yarn Barn & Courtyard

37 High Street

*** Cakes * Plants * Books * Bric-a-Brac ***

*** Craft items ***

*** Exhibition in the Dove showing
future plans and activities ***

Refreshments all day

Cream Teas during the afternoon

All Welcome

In aid of St Mary’s Church, Kington

Teas in the Church

Sundays in July and

2, 9, 16 and 30 August

**(on 23 August the teas will be served from 10 - 4 at
the Yarn Barn as part of the Kington Street Market)**

2.30pm - 5.30pm

**St Mary’s Church,
Kington**



All Welcome including Dogs

MONTHLY MUSINGS

Waiting is an experience common to us all, and frequently annoying. But, like it or not, we are all waiters! If not living our lives in the past, reviewing it through rose-coloured spectacles, we are probably living them in the future, looking forward to imagined bliss (or the reverse!). So what do you think of the prospect of *everlasting life*. Just think about it, life just going on and on and on and on – getting older and older, or simply stuck at a certain age? Ugh! So what about *eternal life*? Is it just the same? Read what Buechner wrote about this, years ago, in one of his many fascinating books, “Wishful Thinking”:

“Eternity is not endless time or the opposite of time. It is the essence of time. If you spin a pinwheel fast enough, then all the colours blend into a single colour, white, which is the essence of the colours of all the spectrum combined. If you spin time fast enough, then time-past, time-present and time-to-come all blend into a timelessness or eternity, which is the essence of all times combined...”

God, as Isaiah says (57.15) “*inhabitheth eternity*” but stands with one foot in time. The part of time where he stands in time most particularly is Christ, and thus in Christ we catch a glimpse of what eternity is all about and what we ourselves are all about too.”

We are reminded that there probably have been experiences or special events in our lives when we have become touched with that sort of otherness, when time has seemed to stand still. For the disciples, for example, Buechner suggests, such an experience might have been to do with the pain and beauty of the death and resurrection.

I suspect that many of us know what he means: those happenings, thoughts, spiritual experiences which, I believe, compose what I mean by the soul, or therefore, to borrow

Beuchner’s colourful phrase, *have one foot in eternity*. And that is, I suggest, perhaps all of us that’s worth keeping.

And this seems to throw light on the meaning of a frequently quoted prophecy of Joel during Pentecost: *I will pour out my spirit on all flesh. Your sons and your daughters shall prophesy. The old shall dream dreams and the young shall see visions* (2.8). Such visions and dreams, if and when we have them *just may* be times when we have one foot in eternity.

So perhaps we should realise that *eternal life* is quite different from *everlasting life*. It exists timelessly. Yet the terms *everlasting* and *eternal* are, it seems to me, even, or perhaps especially, in religious parlance, often used indiscriminately, even though the difference in their meanings is so important.

So, what are we waiting for?

Denis Parry.

KINGTON COMMUNITY LUNCH CLUB

Come and enjoy a 2-course meal
in a friendly environment with
other local seniors at:

Kington Parish Hall

(HR5 3AG)

at 12:30 p.m.

Cost is £6

We meet on the
3rd Wednesday of each month.

Next lunch is on 19th August

Contact: Sarah 01544 598125

KINGTON SHOW

Saturday 12th September 2026



**Come and see:
HORSES, SHEEP, CATTLE,
OPEN & FUN DOG SHOWS,
OG PERFORMANCE HORSES
HORTICULTURAL TENT, YOUNG FARMERS,
SHEARING, TRADE STANDS
AND MUCH MORE.**

A Great day out for all the family!

Open 9am-6pm

Dogs on leads welcome

**Free return bus from Kington Primary school to the
showground throughout the day**

For Early bird tickets - scan the QR code

Adults £15.00

10-17yrs £6.00

Under 10s free



For more information:

www.kingtonshow.co.uk Tel 01544 340598

Moving On

In February 2023, a group of volunteers opened the doors to the Old Sunday School Room at Kington Baptist Church and welcomed young people to the first Kington Youth Club session.

The aim of the club is to provide a safe space for young people between the ages of 10 and 16, a place where they can relax and enjoy a variety of activities. These activities include table football, table-tennis and pool. The club also provides snacks and hot food.

In 2025, Kington Youth Hub CIC (Community Interest Company) who run the club, obtained a grant to employ a dedicated youth worker. This is the only employed post, everyone else volunteers. Lucy took up her post at the start of June and provides a stabilising presence.

This was not the only change that occurred in June. Following notice of the impending sale of the Baptist Church, the Youth Club needed to find a new home. After consultation with the young people, we moved to the Parish Hall at the top of Church Street. We had to adapt to the new space and needed to purchase a storage shed. The Parish Hall has a much bigger kitchen, more toilets and an outdoor space.

Easy Sudoku

5					2			8
	8	3	1			9		4
9			8			1	5	
			9				8	3
	6	9	7	4	8	5	2	
8	1				6			
	9	2			4			6
6		4			9	2	1	
1			6					5

Youth Clubs are vitally important to our young people. They have been shown to help build confidence and social skills; they combat isolation and reduce anti-social behaviours. The club can also be used to build wider community relationships. Currently the number of young people who use the club on a Wednesday varies between 8 and 20. We would like to build on this and offer more activities, especially craft-based activity for those young people who prefer less physical activities. To do this we require more volunteers.

Volunteering with us could help to positively change a young person's life experience. Not only that but you could take part in activity days and even learn new skills. All volunteers receive training from Young Solutions and are never required to work on their own. Can you help? For more information, please email admin@kingtonyouthhub.org

We take this opportunity to thank everyone who has supported Kington Youth Hub to this point and look forward to seeing you in the Community Shop at the end of August.

Christine, Catherine & Philippa
Kington Youth Hub Directors.

Intermediate Sudoku

7				2	1			3
		8	3	5				
		4						
	9	1			4			
	6						2	
			8			1	5	
						6		
				3	8	7		
3			2	9				4

Not a Proper Gardener (Part 65)

Today is July 4th. Climate Change has a lot to answer for. The weather is simply unpredictable and unreliable. I wrote last month about the Spring's fooling about, and now at the end of June, we've endured an insufferable heatwave and the threat of third on the way. And it's so dry. The showers and storms in various areas have mostly missed us, apart from that noisy one in the night two or three weeks ago. Our little pond is a wet mat of sludge and green algae, rapidly drying up. The Arrow and Back Brook are sluggish, and cows are grazing on the greenery in Tattymoor Pool! One hardly dares to think about what some of the farmers must be going through!

So, what of the jungle? Suffering from dizziness (me I mean, not the jungle!) my contribution is very limited. The lot has fallen on Emma with just a little hand from Giles, using a water-can after tea each day. Most plants are growing, but slowly and unproductively. However, we are enjoying a good crop of broad beans, and the birds are thankful for the raspberries, though much pecked by their trying to extract juice to feed thirsty chicks. Other soft fruit has done its best, but all's inconveniently coming at once. Tree fruits are a mixture. Some were caught by that nasty late frost sprung on us when the blossom was out; the rest is tempted to ripen prematurely and could do with a good soaking, as could also the whole jungle. The outer hedges are beautifully looked after for us by Gareth, but he's held back a bit this year on the insides on account of the birds still nesting there.

So how is the livestock? Well, the hedgehogs still enjoy their daily high teatime calci worms, and the frogs enjoy sitting on the algae mat in the pond. The birds are particularly spoilt by Emma with healthy food, including her named favourites, the



blackbirds, of whom Parker (the nosy one) has now been joined by Knowles, plus Nike, of course, and Peter Pointer (on account of an extra sharp beak). These, when anyone enters the kitchen, are there like a shot on the sill, looking in hopefully. And Emma, of course, simply can't refuse.

Incidentally, we've a couple of healthy little oak trees in pots, if anyone could use them.

Happy gardening, Denis.



The Cart Shed
Transforming Lives

Monty Don in conversation with Mary Rhodes

Weobley Church

Friday 11th September 2026, 7pm

Tickets £30 to include light refreshments



Monty Don (BBC Gardeners World) will be 'in conversation' with Mary Rhodes (BBC Midlands Today), talking about a life in gardening, emotional wellbeing and living well. Enjoy an evening in the beautiful Church of St Peter & St Paul in Weobley. Tickets available to purchase online following the link or QR code:



<https://www.trybooking.com/uk/GHUO>

OAK | Open Arms Kingston August events

Events and opening at The Oxford Arms, Kingston, August 2026.

Details for all events on our website (openarmskington.co.uk).

Tel: 07301081444, email info@openarmskington.co.uk.



Monday 3rd August 10.30am-12.30pm. *Digital Skills Lesson 3.* Please email to book a place. Free.

Wednesday 5th August, 10am-12.30pm. *Sunflower Social at Places of Welcome.* A hidden disabilities support group and network, meeting in The Oxford's barn on the first Wednesday of the month during our regular Places Of Welcome opening hours. Free.

Wednesday 5th August 1-5pm, & Thursday 6th August, 10am-2pm (includes lunch). *A two-day photography workshop* for young people 14-18 with photographer Paul Ligas. Free but booking essential, please contact us by email to book.

Wednesday 12th August, 10am-12.30pm. *Dementia Matters at Places of Welcome.* Support group and network for people affected by dementia, meeting in The Oxford's barn on the second Wednesday of the month during our regular Places Of Welcome opening hours. Free.

Tuesday 25th August, 6-9pm. *A talk on the History of Women's Suffrage in Herefordshire* by Clare Wichbold. Bar open throughout, talk begins around 7pm. Free.

Friday 28th August, 6-10pm. *Quiz night at The Oxford Arms.* Teams of max 4 people, £3pp entry, cash prize for the winning team. Bar open throughout.

Sunday 30th August, 2-4pm. *Creative Workshop at The Oxford Arms.* This month's activity is giant crepe flowers! Payment by donation (suggested £5). Live 100 Club draw at 3pm. Bar and café open 1-5pm.

Regular opening hours in August:

Places of Welcome at The Oxford Arms, every Wednesday morning in August, 10am-12.30pm

Country Market at The Oxford Arms, every Friday morning in August, 9am-12pm

OAK | Open Arms Kingston CiC www.openarmskington.co.uk comms@openarmskington.co.uk

August

Please get in touch if your group is within a 10 mile radius of Kingston and would like to be added to a small waiting list who will be offered any vacancies as they arise

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Adrian Wilcox

kingtoncommunityshop@outlook.com

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05-Aug-26

12-Aug-26

19-Aug-26

26-Aug-26

Kington Museum

New Radnor WI

Kington Youth Club

Kington & District
Operatic Society (KADOS)

News From the Museum

Rope Making in Kington

In the late 1800's the Elcox family was busy making ropes on the Kingswood Road, between the Toll house and the Redlands house. It was also known as "Ropewalk" as shown in the old maps of Kington maps.

James Elcox was born in 1822 on a Greek Island. Although the family were very much Kingtonians. James is listed in 1852 as a rope and twine spinner "and Parish Constable" living in Bridge Gate Row possibly opposite the former Bridge Inn. He was succeeded by his son James born 1850, then brother William born 1870 in Ashmoor Place, Kingswood.

The hemp used in rope making may well have been grown in Herefordshire or brought in from Shropshire as references are made to hemp -yards on the farms and to some cottage gardens, which the wife would tend, to help pay.

Ella Mary Leather writes in "Folklore of Herefordshire" It is well known hemp seed charm, the girl must walk 12 times around the churchyard at midnight on St John's Eve June 23-24 without stopping repeating "Hempseed I sow, Hemp seed I hoe, Let him that is my true love, Come after me and mow". Apparently, the form of her lover then appears to her! Writing in 1912, this has been carried out in Weobley within living memory.

Britain had been making rope for 500 years, using the rope walks, which were long narrow alleys. The method used involved no more than two workers, workers, with the fibrous raw material wound around his waist, would pay it out while walking backwards along the ropewalk, which could be up to a third of a mile long. The ends would then be attached on hooks to a traveller, which was on wheels.

At the same time a man or boy would turn the wheel with hooks to which the fibre was fastened and in this way the ropes would be spun. Every twenty yards there would be a T

shaped post called a beaver or skirder which had a row of up pointing pegs to keep the yarn apart. When all strands of the fibre were in place and secured at both ends then a strand top was put in place, the handle was cranked and the traveller moved as the strands were twisted together forming a rope. Rope was sold in strand widths and lengths.

James Elcox is mentioned in the Skarratt diaries as arriving from Australia, but he did not strike gold there. Settling down in Kington, he had quite a social life, joining a "private brass band" with other businessmen of the town, giving concerts, some musical pieces were quite good, but others left room for improvement. James also sang at an evening of entertainment, on which Scarratt commented "Not a very attractive programme, not well executed – room little more than half full, with the occupiers of the back row not very well behaved.

We have the Charity shop 5th -11th August. Donations welcomed.

Wendy Jones

KINGTON LIBRARY

During the school holidays as part of the Summer Reading Challenge for children, we have the following events at Kington Library.

6th August two sessions of Bookmark sewing fun 2pm and 3 pm These sessions are free but booking essential.

13th August Blast off with Fizz Pop Science 1.30pm and Music adventure with Fizz Pop Science 3pm There is a charge of £3 per child per session for these events. Booking essential.

Please book sessions via our Eventbrite page accessible through our website (Herefordshire.gov.uk/libraries, visit a library, events) .

Herefordshire.gov.uk

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www.kingtonwalks.org

Caring for God's Acre

Just another butterfly on the Wall

As August rolls in, you might start to see some new wings fluttering in your local churchyard. The Wall Brown or Wall butterfly is named after its habit of basking casually on walls or rocky places. This behaviour allows the butterfly to raise its temperature enough to fly around comfortably. Perfectly camouflaged against stones, the best way to identify the species is by checking the eyespots on its wings. One large eyespot on the forewing and four smaller ones on the hindwing is a dead giveaway that you have a Wall on your hands. The Wall's habitat is diverse across England and Wales, spanning coastal zones, open grassland, disused quarries, railway edges, gardens, field edges and even churchyards and cemeteries. They may be found in sunny spots, basking on warm stone monuments, walls surrounding the churchyard, or the gravel of kerbed graves. Walls lay their eggs on grass tussocks and the broader leaves of coarse grasses such as Yorkshire Fog. Larvae and caterpillars will munch away on the grasses, while the butterflies rely on a variety of grassland wildflowers for nectar.

Inland Wall populations saw dramatic decreases in the 1980s, but not for the reasons you might expect. Habitat loss and degradation or abandonment of traditional farming or forestry practices didn't fit the bill for the Wall, so researchers instead had to come up with other theories.

Belgium researchers discovered they were witnessing similar decline with their Wall populations, so decided to do some digging. They proposed that warming climates were causing the species to have a third brood late in the year, leaving little time for the caterpillars

... we can expect inland Wall populations to experience strong natural selection as climates warm, eventually recovering and becoming as resilient as their coastal relatives...



to develop before winter. This brood was then unfortunately lost, causing the downward spiral. Though, this might not be the end for the inland populations. Many butterfly species can change their voltinism (the number of generations produced per year). This

flexibility allows species to respond quickly and often unexpectedly to years with favourable conditions, producing more broods than would be typical. Based on this principle, we can expect inland Wall populations

to experience strong natural selection as climates warm, eventually recovering and becoming as resilient as their coastal relatives, where temperatures are more consistent.

It's a waiting game for the Wall, but in the meantime, we can be doing our part to support the species. Leaving coarse, grassy and sunny patches in your churchyard or garden gives them places to do their sunbathing. Creating gorgeous wildflower meadow areas gives the Wall, as well as many other pollinators and invertebrates, lots of variety for food. If you spot a Wall, be sure to record it in your iNaturalist app or send us a photo, especially if you see one in your local churchyard or burial ground. Every record builds a picture of just how important burial grounds are for wildlife.

Kaitlyn Elverson

Engagement Officer, Nature in Sacred Places Project (NiSP)

KINGTON TOWN COUNCIL UPDATE



The event of the month (or possibly the year) was Armed Forces Day, which took place on 27th June at Lady Hawkins' School.



The Town Council had been busily preparing for the town to host the event on behalf of the County. The first time we have had the honour of doing so.

On the day, the sun shone and all the planning paid off, when around 600 gathered at the school War Memorial for a moving tribute to our armed services, and to those former students of the school who had given their lives.

The celebration started with the raising of the Union flag as a trumpeter played Reveille. The ceremony was led by Senior Students and staff from the school. At its close the Lord Lieutenant, Mr Edward Harley laid a wreath at the memorial, inspected the troops, then took the salute as they marched to the band tent.

The Armed Forces Covenant was signed by Cllr Sell on behalf of Kington Town Council and by The Royal British Legion Eardisley Branch. The many visiting dignitaries and members of the public were then invited to tour the charity stalls, military stands and display of military vehicles as the Ludlow Concert Band, led by their conductor and Kingtonian, David Redmayne, played an entertaining and varied programme.

Cllr. Philip Sell

All who attended said how much they had enjoyed the occasion. Many messages of thanks have been received, including these below...

Thank you for organising such a wonderful Armed Forces Day in Kington. It was a really splendid occasion with just the right degree of pomp and formality, whilst also being accessible to all. I was most impressed with the number of people who attended, and it was clear (from all spoke to) how much the event was being enjoyed and appreciated. Kindly pass my thanks to so many who contributed.

Edward Harley

HM Lord Lieutenant of Herefordshire.

It was a huge pleasure to be part of your wonderful Armed Forces Day at Lady Hawkins School on Saturday. Thank you so much for inviting me. I was particularly impressed by the wonderful presentation given by the students, which each of them carried off faultlessly in front of the beautiful and simple war memorial.

Tamsin Clive DL,

The High Sheriff of Herefordshire

Clearly much thought had gone into the occasion and the link to the service personnel and old scholars from the school was very memorable.

Philip C Evason

Chair SSAFA Herefordshire

Just a quick note to say a big thank you and congratulations for all your efforts in organising an excellent Armed Forces Day in Kington!

It was a very moving event, and I really valued hearing the service stories of several former students of the school. The current students spoke beautifully. It was also great to have a chance to chat to so many others, including stall holders, during the event. Thank you for doing Herefordshire proud!

Dr Ellie Chowns MP

North Herefordshire

Colonel Andy Taylor sent this simple message, which summarised the whole event....

WHAT A TRIUMPH !!!

From Lady Hawkins School

As part of English Language mock examinations, our Year 10 students were challenged to produce a piece of descriptive writing inspired by an image.

The following extract showcases an exceptional response describing a jungle setting.

Through rich sensory detail and atmospheric description, Violet Underhill transports the reader into a world teeming with life and beauty. Her thoughtful use of language demonstrates the creativity and technical skill that can be achieved through careful planning and a strong understanding of descriptive techniques.

We hope you enjoy reading this impressive example of Year 10 creative writing.

Miss Moss

The golden locks of the sun's light painted the sky with gorgeous, exuberant shades of cobalt, fuchsia and marigold. It blessed the clouds with its warm, gentle, inviting touch as they travelled throughout the sky like an ocean wave lapping the shores of sunlight. The eternally vibrant flocks of birds paraded through the sky in a wondrous display of beauty, enchanting the sun in a dance of gratitude for the lustrous light it bestowed upon them. A singular cockatoo began its descent through the trees' canopy. Its delicate feathers gently caressed the beautiful bushes of leaves at the crest of every branch, dislodging a lone young leaf from its mother's safe embrace.

The leaf danced and twirled in the warm humid air as it gracefully floated down towards the ground. The surroundings were astounding. A calm colony of ants orderly ushered the young leaf from its position in order to preserve the beauty of the forest. As it was carried along the forest floor, it passed such wondrous sights. A collection of alliums swayed in the calming company of each other while a family of monkeys embraced each other in a tender display of affection.

Suddenly, they parted ways, floating down from branch to branch with the grace and confidence of a ballerina, unaware whether they will ever see one another again but so is the life of a monkey in a jungle. Unpredictable.

Violet Underhill- Year 10

Brilley Flicks in the Sticks

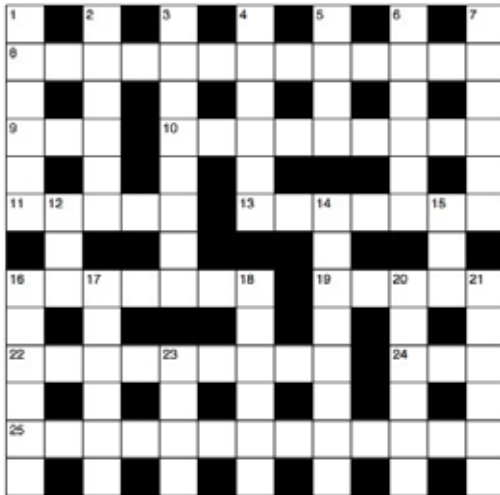
Thursday 3rd September at 7.30: Hamnet (12A), £5

Hamnet tells the powerful love story behind the creation of Shakespeare's timeless masterpiece, Hamlet. After the death of their son Hamnet, Agnes and William Shakespeare are left to grapple with grief. Set in 16th-century England, Hamnet was primarily filmed in Herefordshire, including Weobley and Brilley, chosen for their beautiful landscapes and Tudor-era architecture.

Brilley and Michaelchurch Village Hall (HR3 6JG), doors open at 7pm. Don't forget to bring your own refreshments!

As usual advance booking only - please book and pay for your tickets online at pay-brilley.co.uk

August Crossword



Across

- 1 Proverbs describes her as being 'of noble character' (Proverbs 31:10) (4)
- 3 'Shall we go up again — against the Benjamites, our brothers?' (Judges 20:23) (2,6)
- 8 A descendant of Shem (Genesis 10:28) (4)
- 9 'Anyone who does not carry his cross and follow me cannot be my — ' (Luke 14:27) (8)
- 11 Resentment(Ephesians 4:31)(10)
- 14 In Cain(anag.)(6)
- 15 'Such knowledge is too wonderful for me, too lofty for me to—' (Psalm 139:6) (6)
- 17 Intense (1 Thessalonians 4:5)(10)
- 20 Third Order of the Roman Catholic Church(8)
- 21 'At midnight the cry rang out, "Here's the bridegroom!Come out to — him"' (Matthew 25:6) (4)
- 22 'My grace is sufficient for you, for my power is made perfect in — ' (2 Corinthians 12:9) (8)
- 23 'As the — pants for streams of water,so my soul pants for you, O God' (Psalm 42:1) (4)

Down

- 1 Nickname of popular First World War chaplain, the Revd G.A. Studdert Kennedy, — Willie (8)
- 2 Occasion of religious joy (Lamentations 2:22) (5,3)
- 4 'We three kings of — are' (6)
- 5 Allegation or charge (Jude 9) (10)
- 6 Kind (1 Chronicles 12:33) (4)
- 7 'Open your — and look at the fields!' (John 4:35) (4)
- 10 Also known as the Feast of Lights (John10:22)(10)
- 12 Area that saw the healing of two demon - possessed men and a herd of pigs stampeding to their deaths (Matthew 8:28) (8)
- 13 Forebear(James2:21)(8)
- 16 Name given to the first two books of the Apocrypha(6)
- 18 Esau sold his birthright for this (Genesis25:34)(4)
- 19 Rear(anag.)(4)

Answers Page

Easy Sudoku

5	7	1	4	9	2	3	6	8
2	8	3	1	6	5	9	7	4
9	4	6	8	7	3	1	5	2
4	2	7	9	5	1	6	8	3
3	6	9	7	4	8	5	2	1
8	1	5	2	3	6	7	4	9
7	9	2	5	1	4	8	3	6
6	5	4	3	8	9	2	1	7
1	3	8	6	2	7	4	9	5

Crossword

S	S	S	C	S	M	F						
P	R	I	N	C	E	O	F	P	E	A	C	E
R	N	O	M	U	T	E						
I	N	F	U	N	M	A	R	R	I	E	D	
N	U	R	I							N	O	
G	U	L	A	G	T	R	E	A	S	O	N	
	R		E				R			W		
I	N	A	I	D	O	F	A	R	E	N	A	
N	T					R	S		M		D	
C	A	L	V	I	N	I	S	T	P	A	D	
O	A		N	E		I		I				
M	O	S	E	S	A	N	D	A	A	R	O	N
E	T		T		D		N		E			G

Intermediate Sudoku

7	5	9	4	2	1	8	6	3
6	2	8	3	5	7	9	4	1
1	3	4	6	8	9	2	7	5
2	9	1	5	7	4	3	8	6
8	6	5	9	1	3	4	2	7
4	7	3	8	6	2	1	5	9
9	1	2	7	4	5	6	3	8
5	4	6	1	3	8	7	9	2
3	8	7	2	9	6	5	1	4

Wordsearch

E	E	Q	E	U	Q	I	N	U	D	E
G	G	C	R	C	Y	D	D	U	M	E
N	G	B	A	P	T	I	S	T	S	A
E	G	M	P	R	I	G	R	E	A	T
L	E	B	E	Y	R	O	T	S	I	H
L	N	I	R	R	U	E	B	C	A	G
A	J	A	P	E	C	U	S	U	T	U
H	H	O	D	E	S	E	R	T	Y	O
C	E	E	H	R	B	U	G	S	E	R
U	A	A	M	N	O	E	G	N	U	D
D	D	U	T	Y	R	J	H	T	E	S

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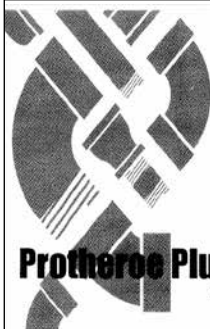
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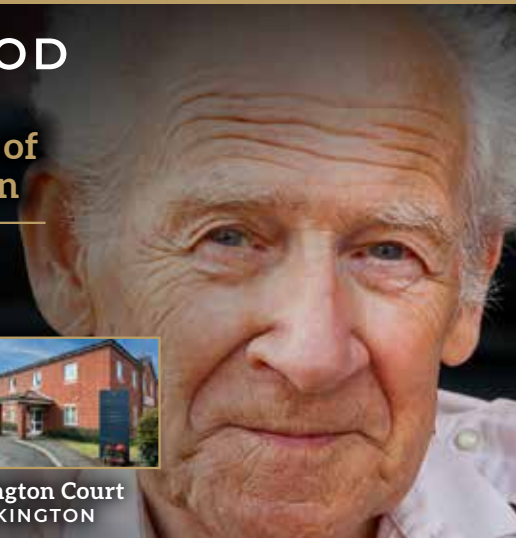
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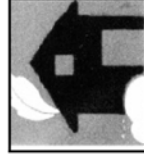
Knighton Library

41	41	41	41	41	41	41
M>F	M>Sa	M>Sa	M>Sa	M>Sa	M>Sa	M>Sa
06:10	08:20	10:10	12:10	15:20	17:30	
06:18	08:28	10:19	12:19	15:19	17:39	
06:40	-	10:48	12:45	15:55	18:05	
	08:53	10:54	12:47	15:57	-	

41	41	41	41	41	41	41
M>F	M>Sa	M>Sa	M>Sa	M>Sa	M>Sa	M>Sa
06:38	09:07	11:09	13:03	16:13	18:03	
06:42	09:11	11:13	13:07	16:17	18:07	
07:04	09:35	11:35	13:34	16:39	18:27	
07:14	09:45	11:45	13:44	16:49	18:37	

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Llandrindod Wells Railway Station Crossgates Kington. Mill St arr	461 M>F	461 C	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa
Kington, Mill St dep Hereford Old Market Hereford Station	06:40		07:20	08:50	09:50	10:50	11:50	12:50	13:50	14:50	15:50	16:50	17:10	19:37	22:00				
	07:32		08:30	09:47	10:53	11:47	12:47	13:49	13:46	14:47	15:47	16:49	16:53	18:02	20:24	Request			
	07:37		08:35	09:52	10:58	11:52	12:52	13:55	13:58	14:52	15:52	16:55	16:58	18:07	20:27	Request			
	461 M>Sa	461 M>F	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa	461 M>Sa
Hereford Station Hereford Maylord Kington Mill St arr																			
Kington Mill St dep Crossgates Llandrindod Wells Station	07:50		10:10	11:10	12:10	13:10	14:10			16:10	17:15h	17:35	18:10						
	08:21		10:41	11:41	12:41	13:41	14:41			16:41	17:45h	18:06	18:41						
	08:39		10:47	11:47	12:55	13:47	14:47			16:55	17:52h	18:12	18:47						

Key:

Monday to Saturday

Sundays only

C Operates Hereford College days only

School holidays $M > F$

School holidays + Sat

Please verify with Sargeants for the most up to date timings and if Sunday buses are running on the route you require.

Forthcoming events

<i>August</i>	<i>Time</i>	<i>Event</i>	<i>Venue & Contact</i>
Sun 2 nd	2.30 – 5.00pm	Cream Teas	St Mary's
<i>Every Sunday during August</i>			St Mary's Church
Sun 2 nd	6.00pm	Prayer and Praise Evening	St Mary's
Mon 3 rd	12.15 – 1.00 pm	Kington Zero Waste	Parish Hall
<i>Repeated Weekly</i>			
Fri 7 th	10.00– 11.00am	Kington Zero Waste	Parish Hall
<i>Repeated Weekly</i>			
Sat 8 th	2.00pm	Titely Village Fete	Stagg Meadow
Sun 9 th	5.00pm	The Derby Singers will sing Choral Evensong. This will be followed by tea/cake and a short Organ Recital by Tom Corfield, formerly of Derby Cathedral.	St Mary's, Kington
Tues 11 th	10 – 12.30	Stay & Play Picnic	Parish Hall
Tues 11 th	7.00 pm	Beetle Drive	Parish Hall
Wed 19 th	3.30pm	Lego Club	St Mary's
Sun 23 rd	6.00 pm (rehearsal 5.00 pm, tea 5.30)	Choral Evensong	Huntington Church
Tues 25 th	10 – 12.30am	Stay & Play Picnic	Parish Hall
Fri 28 th	7.00pm	'The Romans in Radnorshire' Talk by Dr Marian Evans	St Stephen's, Old Radnor

FOR DETAILS OF CHURCH SERVICES PLEASE SEE KINGTON PARISHES PAGE 6

You can also find details of many cultural events and activities in Broad Sheep: www.broadsheep.com and www.visitherefordshire.co.uk

If you would like a church or community event publicised in the Diary please contact the Diary Editor: Rev.Paul.C.Roberts@gmail.com

MATERIAL FOR THE SEPTEMBER 2026 PARISH NEWS by 10th August 2026

Please send by email (maximum 500 words) to:
pn.kingtonparishes@gmail.com

Note: The cut-off date is always the 10th of the previous month